

DEMOCRACY

DR. MD NURUL AMIN

Professor

Dept. of Humanities, BUET

Democracy

- Greek Word ‘Demos’ (People) and ‘Kratos’ (Power)
- Democracy means the rule of People
- Popular definition : Abraham Lincoln “Democracy is the govt. of the people, by the people and for the people”
- Lord Bryce, J .S. Mill, C. F. Strong also gave definition

Definition

- It is regarded as the best form of govt.
- J.S. Mill : 3 Conditions
 - It is a way of life. People must be willing to accept it
 - Presentations of peoples rights and freedoms
 - People must be ready to discharge their duties

Characteristics

- People enjoy sovereign power
- Liberty and equality
- Universal adult suffrage
- Multiplicity of political parties
- Rule of law/Justice
- Responsiveness

Types of Democracy

Two Types:

- **1)Direct** (Exist in ancient Greece city state & Roman city state, now in 5 Cantons of Switzerland)
- **2)Indirect** (Modern is indirect or representative, Bangladesh, India, USA)

Merits of Democracy

- **Savior of individual liberties**
- Upholds the principle of equality
- **Efficient form of government**
- Enlightens the masses politically
- **Instills Patriotism**
- Immune from danger of revolutions
- **Assures progress and order**
- Ennobles the noble
- **Imparts training of citizenship**
- Govt. by specialist & peoples representatives

Demerits of Democracy

- **Rule of Ignorance (Plato....Aristotle)**
- **Unstable form of Government**
- **Political parties pollute politics**
- **Emphasis on quantity rather than quality**
- **Encourage bribery and corruption**
- **MYTH> Power of People**
- **No quick decision in national emergency (leaders & head consult)**
- **Expensive Government (Election Campaign)**

Conditions/Prerequisites for the Success of Democracy

- Good Citizen
- Literacy
- Written Constitution
- Wise leadership
- Social and economic equality
- Freedom of express (Print or electronic)
- Political consciousness & intelligence
- Multi Political Party
- Sound and effective opposition
- Experiment in Local self government
- No corruption
- Rule of law and Independency of Judiciary
-

Thank you